TOPIC REPORTS: ICT INDUSTRY

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

AI · ICT INDUSTRY · INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM

Algeria · Angola · Egypt · Eswatini · Kenya · Madagascar · Mauritius · Mozambique · Nigeria · Senegal · South Africa · Tanzania · Uganda

Algeria

STATE ELECTRONICS GROUP'S DIGITAL AND PAYMENTS PROGRAMME ABROAD

- **Algerian Company INATEL Signs Strategic Agreement for New Kinshasa City Project** — Africa News (DZ), 3 September 2026 DRC

  Algeria's state electronics firm INATEL, in a consortium with PGS Africa and DABYAN, signed a memorandum with the committee overseeing the Kinshasa city expansion project in the DR Congo to deploy payment systems, digital equipment and a technology centre covering cybersecurity and applied AI. The signing date is given only as recent, and no value or timetable is disclosed.

- **Inatel signe un accord strategique pour le projet de nouvelle ville de Kinshasa** — Algerie Eco, 4 September 2026 DRC

  The Algerian state electronics firm INATEL, with PGS Africa and DABYAN, signed a protocol with the coordination of the DRC's Kinshasa expansion project for an integrated digital, industrial and technological programme covering digital technologies, electronic payment systems, digital equipment and services, knowledge transfer and a centre for innovation in payment systems, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence. No amount is stated.

Angola

TELECOMMUNICATIONS AND ICT CONTRIBUTION TO GDP

- **Secretário de Estado reconhece contributo das telecomunicações na economia** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 5 September 2026

  Angola's secretary of state for telecommunications, Ângelo Buta João, said on 5 September 2026 that the telecoms, ICT and media sector's contribution to GDP grew 14.3% in the second quarter of 2026. He spoke at the close of the FITITEL technology fair in Luanda, which drew 7,000 visitors and was themed on cybersecurity and digital trust.

Egypt

ACQUISITION OF A TEACHER SOFTWARE COMPANY BY A REGIONAL EDUCATION PLATFORM

- **Abwaab rachète l'entreprise égyptienne EduAct** — wearetech.africa, 2 September 2026

Jordanian education platform Abwaab acquired the Egyptian company EduAct, which builds software for tutoring centres to manage courses, payments and student tracking. The combination pairs online learning content with physical tutoring centres in Egypt. No transaction date, price or terms are stated.

DOMESTIC AI COMPANY EXPANSION INTO GULF MARKETS

- **L'entreprise égyptienne d'intelligence artificielle Velents s'implante au Bahreïn** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  An Egyptian enterprise artificial intelligence company has expanded into Bahrain with a local telecommunications operator. The partnership is to offer businesses there autonomous virtual assistants automating customer service, sales and recruitment, under local data-protection rules.

INTELOGIX CAIRO DELIVERY HUB

- **InteLogix opens AI hub in Cairo** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  InteLogix opened an artificial-intelligence delivery hub in Cairo, inaugurated by Egypt's Information Technology Industry Development Agency. The company says it plans to grow the site from about 135 employees to 1,365 over three years.

Eswatini

BUY ESWATINI MARKET-ACCESS PLATFORM

- **Taiwan Opens Global Markets for Eswatini Through Buy Eswatini** — Eswatini Positive News, 5 September 2026

  The Taiwan-funded Buy Eswatini digital commerce platform was handed to the Eswatini Investment Promotion Authority at the 58th Eswatini International Trade Fair on 3 September 2026. Eswatini's commerce minister asked Taiwan to fund a third phase covering platform infrastructure, data protection, digital payments, logistics and training for small businesses. No value is given for Taiwan's support or the request.

Kenya

FIBRE OPERATOR REPOSITIONING INTO AI AND CLOUD SERVICES

- **Interview: Liquid bets on AI as next growth frontier for Africa's fibre network** — TechTrends KE, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  The same operator is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its fibre backbone, its vice-president and chief executive said at a Nairobi conference. Connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product, he argued, naming data-centre capacity as the concern African telecom executives raise most.

- **Interview: Liquid targets Africa's data centre gap** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  A pan-African fibre operator's Kenyan chief executive says the continent's data-centre capacity is becoming a major concern for African telecom executives, as the business pushes deeper into artificial intelligence and cloud services. He puts Africa at 0.6 per cent of the world's data-centre capacity.

GOVERNMENT SALE OF A 15% STAKE IN THE LARGEST TELCO

- **Kenya's High Court voids Vodacom's $1.5 billion Safaricom takeover** — TechCabal, 15 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

A three-judge High Court bench voided the government's sale of a 15 per cent Safaricom stake, a KES 204.3bn transaction that closed less than three months earlier, ruling it unconstitutional because key information was withheld from the public, the cabinet and parliament.

- **Safaricom ruling crucial** — Daily Nation, 16 September 2026

  The Daily Nation's editorial welcomes the Kenyan High Court ruling that annulled the government's Sh204.3 billion sale of its 15% Safaricom stake to Vodacom Group as unconstitutional. The court found inadequate public participation, concealment of material information and bypassed regulatory review, and ordered the 6 billion shares returned to state ownership.

- **Vodacom, Kenya to appeal court ruling voiding Safaricom sale** — Connecting Africa, 16 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom and Kenya's Treasury both said on 16 September 2026 that they will appeal the High Court ruling that voided the sale of a 15% government stake in Safaricom. The court found the deal lacked meaningful public participation and hid material information, and ordered the stake returned to the state.

M-KOPA ACQUISITION OF A DEVICE-LOCKING SOFTWARE COMPANY

- **M-KOPA acquires Finnish device-locking company KilpiTek Oy for $8 million** — TechCabal, 7 October 2026

  M-KOPA's financial statements show it completed the US$8m acquisition of a Finnish device-locking software company on 26 March 2026, US$2.67m of it in cash. The purchase brings in-house the technology that restricts financed smartphones when customers fall behind.

MICROSOFT AFRICA DEVELOPMENT CENTRE, NAIROBI

- **Microsoft to shut Nairobi engineering centre, putting hundreds of jobs at risk** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft is winding down its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi, staff were told on 12 October, putting nearly 400 jobs at risk with fewer than 10 expected to remain. The company confirmed only proposed changes to its engineering operations; Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary, briefed the same day, agreed a joint action plan with it.

- **Microsoft's Nairobi Development Centre Faces Possible Closure** — Kenyans.co.ke, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft plans to close the engineering department of its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi after more than seven years, a Kenyan outlet reports. Between 400 and 500 employees could be affected.

Madagascar

ASAN'AI DIGITAL AND OUTSOURCING TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **99 young people certified in BPO trades after seven-week Asanai training (Madagascar)** — 2424.mg, 24 September 2026

  Madagascar's Asanai programme certified 99 of the 111 trainees in its second seven-week cohort in business process outsourcing skills on 24 September 2026. The programme is run by the digital development ministry with World Bank support through the Integrated Growth Poles (PIC) project and delivered with ArkeUp Academy.

Mauritius

DEVELOPMENT-FUND STAKE IN A DOMESTIC DIGITAL SERVICES FIRM

- **Le fonds AfricInvest investit dans la société mauricienne Spoon Consulting** — wearetech.africa, 7 September 2026

  A pan-African investment fund took a minority stake in a Mauritian digital transformation firm, with no sum disclosed.

Mozambique

PARTIAL SALE OF THE STATE TELECOMMUNICATIONS OPERATOR

- **Governo procura novo investidor para recuperar Tmcel** — Profile, 14 September 2026

  Mozambique's finance ministry has begun selecting a strategic investor to buy part of the state's shares in the state operator Tmcel, reported on 14 September 2026, with a technical team set up to run the negotiations. Tmcel's latest accounts show negative equity of about MZN 14.5 billion, and its auditor EY flagged material uncertainty over its ability to keep operating.

Nigeria

NATIONAL SOFTWARE INDUSTRY REGISTRY

- **ISPON Inaugurates NEC, Harps on National Software Industry Registry** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's institute of software practitioners says it will launch a national software industry registry within six months, announced at the inauguration of its new executive council in Lagos. Its president said the registry will document software achievements and developers to make the industry globally visible, criticising the loss of record of milestones already achieved.

ICT CONTRIBUTION TO GDP

- **ICT Contribution to GDP Rises to 21% - Minister** — Voice of Nigeria, 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications and digital economy minister Bosun Tijani said on 14 September 2026 that the ICT sector's share of GDP has risen from about 16 to 21 per cent in three years. He spoke at the opening of the Nigeria Data Protection Commission's Abuja headquarters, in a property recovered by the EFCC. The commission said it has licensed 356 compliance organisations and earned more than N12 billion in three years.

OUTSOURCE TO NIGERIA INITIATIVE KNOWLEDGE-PROCESS OUTSOURCING PROGRAMME

- **Request for Expression of Interest- Consultancy Services for the Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing and High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry for the iDICE Programme** — Premium Times (notice by the iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, Bank of Industry), 21 September 2026

  Nigeria's Bank of Industry, which runs the iDICE programme, is seeking consultants for a 16-month assignment to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. The brief includes an academy for 1,000 graduates, 200 paid residency places a year, a target of 80% placement within six months of certification, and a framework of rules and tax incentives for delivery centres. iDICE is co-financed by the AfDB, AFD and IsDB; expressions of interest close on 5 October 2026.

- **Terms of Reference: Consultancy Services for Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) for High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative (OTNI) — Investment in Digital and Creative Enterprises (iDICE) Programme** — Bank of Industry (BOI), iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, 21 September 2026

The terms of reference, dated 21 September 2026, for the iDICE consultancy to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. They set five workstreams and a target of paid placement for 80% of trainees within six months. The procurement is summarised under the Premium Times notice.

OPAY NEW YORK LISTING

- **OPay Limited — Form F-1 Registration Statement under the Securities Act of 1933 (filed 9 October 2026)** — OPay Limited, filed with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (EDGAR), 9 October 2026

  OPay Limited, the Nigerian-operated payments company registered in the Cayman Islands with offices in Singapore, filed for an initial public offering with the US Securities and Exchange Commission on 9 October 2026, seeking to list American depositary shares on the New York Stock Exchange as OPAY. It reports 50.1 million monthly active users at 31 July 2026. A Standard Bank Group company has agreed to buy shares in a concurrent private placement of up to US$200 million.

- **Standard Bank to take up to $200-million stake in OPay** — TechCentral, 9 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  OPay, the Nigeria-focused fintech, filed on 9 October 2026 to list in New York; its registration statement shows Standard Bank's Stanbic Africa Holdings will buy up to $200 million of shares in a private placement alongside the IPO, with a 12-month lock-up. OPay reported 50.1 million monthly active users and $339.1 billion of transactions in the first half of 2026.

- **Standard Bank signs OPay investment deal tied to planned US listing** — The African Chronicle, 10 October 2026

  Standard Bank Group has agreed to invest in the payments company OPay, which has filed for a New York listing. The amount is not disclosed, and closing depends on the listing and on regulatory approval.

Senegal

ACQUISITION OF A SENEGALESE HEALTH-TECHNOLOGY COMPANY

- **Alan acquires Senegal's Tanel in rare Francophone healthtech exit** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  French health insurer Alan acquired Dakar-based Tanel in a deal that closed in June 2026 for an undisclosed sum, its first move into Africa and a full exit for Ventures Platform, AAIC Investment and a group of angels. Tanel is a licensed insurer carrying its own risk rather than administering another underwriter's cover, selling employer health plans in Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire across a contracted network of more than 1,200 pharmacies and providers, covering about 70,000 lives and profitable in 2025. Alan had backed Tanel's $2.1 million seed round in 2024, giving it two years of visibility before it approached the founders, who stay on as general managers.

SÉNÉGAL DIGITAL FACTORY POOLED PROCUREMENT FOR LOCAL ASSEMBLY

- **New Deal Technologique : Le Sénégal parie sur la fabrication et l'assemblage locaux** — Seneweb, 1 October 2026

  A delegation from Senegal's telecoms and digital ministry visited SunuCorp's computer assembly plant at Keur Ndiaye Lo on 1 October 2026 under Sénégal Digital Factory, part of the New Deal Technologique, which pools state equipment purchases for local assemblers. The ministry cites 97% 4G coverage but 54% of people without devices; the plant can make about 7,500 computers a year.

SENEGAL DIGITAL FACTORY PARTNERSHIP CONVENTION

- **Un partenariat de près de 88 milliards FCFA pour développer la production locale de solutions technologiques** — APS, 6 October 2026

  Senegal's telecommunications ministry signed a US$150 million partnership convention, nearly CFA 88 billion, with an Africa investment council and the Indian firm Blue Cloud Softech Solutions under the Senegal Digital Factory project. It covers local assembly of electronic devices, quality control, certification and intellectual property; the ministry puts computer hardware imports at CFA 419 billion a year.

South Africa

ONLINE RETAIL AS A SHARE OF NATIONAL RETAIL TURNOVER

- **SA online retail to reach R159-billion in 2026** — World Wide Worx, 2 September 2026

  World Wide Worx's Online Retail in South Africa 2026 study, produced with Mastercard, Peach Payments and Ask Africa, forecasts online retail sales of about R159 billion in 2026, up 22.5%, and its first full year at 10% of national retail turnover. Takealot is used by 35.3% of online shoppers and Checkers Sixty60 by 15%.

CROSS-BORDER E-COMMERCE GROWTH AFTER THE SMALL-PARCEL CONCESSION ENDED

- **South African online shoppers prefer local to Temu, Shein** — Connecting Africa, 4 September 2026

  South African cross-border e-commerce growth fell to 7% in 2025 from an annual range of 30 to 50% before 2024, after the November 2024 removal of the small-parcel import concession put parcels under R500 on the standard 45% duty plus 15% VAT. Shein's growth slowed to 11% and Temu recorded an average monthly decline of 42%, while roughly 19 million cross-border platform orders in 2025 still made up 18.6% of South African e-commerce transactions.

- **Shein, Temu forced to rethink SA e-commerce playbook** — ITWeb South Africa, 9 September 2026

  South Africa's crackdown on low-value imports has significantly slowed cross-border e-commerce growth and pushed the two largest platforms from tax arbitrage towards local fulfilment and supply chains, on the Online Retail in South Africa study.

THE LARGEST DOMESTIC OPERATOR'S INTEREST IN THE KENYAN INCUMBENT

- **Vodacom's Safaricom deal struck down by Kenyan high court** — TechCentral, 15 September 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's High Court on 15 September 2026 declared the government's sale of a 15 per cent Safaricom stake to Vodacom's Vodafone Kenya unconstitutional and ordered the shares returned to the state. The three-judge bench found public participation inadequate and the buyer's identity concealed. The June sale raised KSh204.3 billion; Vodacom said it will appeal and seek a stay.

BANK-OPERATED MOBILE VIRTUAL NETWORK

- **The banker helping FNB Connect turn cellphones into gateways to everyday life** — TechCabal, 18 September 2026

  FNB Connect, the connectivity business of South Africa's First National Bank, recorded R28.6 billion in customer value and sales in its latest financial year, up 18%, and gross revenue of more than R3 billion, its chief executive Sashin Sookroo told TechCabal. Its mobile network data use reached about 50 petabytes, and it has about 1.02 million active SIMs.

STANDARD BANK INVESTMENT IN OPAY

- **Standard Bank Group announces strategic investment in OPay and a partnership to advance financial services access in Africa** — Standard Bank Group, 9 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Standard Bank Group signed a subscription agreement to invest in Nigerian fintech OPay, to close with or shortly after OPay's proposed New York Stock Exchange listing, for which OPay filed with the US SEC on 9 October 2026. The two also plan to explore digital banking, merchant acquiring, lending and remittances. The release states no amount.

Tanzania

ACTIVE FINTECH COMPANIES

- **Tanzania fintechs, banks told to rethink partnerships** — The Citizen, 4 September 2026

  The UN Capital Development Fund counted 171 active fintech companies in Tanzania in 2026, up from 33 in 2021, against more than 70% of adults holding a mobile money account and 6.4 billion digital payment transactions in 2024. Founders and the fund told a Dar es Salaam session that partnerships with banks and mobile operators remain the main barrier to scale, citing banks assessing early-stage firms through a static lens, limited patient capital, talent shortages, regulatory and tax uncertainty and customer acquisition costs.

Uganda

ACQUISITION OF A DOMESTIC BANKING-SOFTWARE FIRM

- **CreditChek rachète Algosys pour faciliter le crédit en Afrique de l'Est** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA

  A Nigerian technology company has acquired a Ugandan banking-software firm, bringing every stage of credit - from verifying the borrower's identity to repayment - onto a single platform. The companies say the combination lets African financial institutions assess loan applications faster and lend more readily; no price is disclosed.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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